

Markelo

Design System

v1.0 — June 2026 — For product and brand teams

This is the single source of truth for all Markelo visuals. If you are unsure about any design decision, the answer is in here. If it is not covered, ask the Head of Design before deciding.

1. Colours

We use a small, intentional palette. Nothing outside this list should appear in any Markelo design.

Note: We never use pure black (#000000) or pure white (#FFFFFF). They are too harsh. Use the values below instead.

Primary

Blue #1A56A0 <i>Buttons, links, active states</i>	Blue Light #E8F1FB <i>Hover backgrounds, tints</i>	Blue Dark #0C3D7A <i>Dark headers, cover slides</i>
--	---	--

Semantic — meaning matters here

Use these only for what they mean. Green = done. Red = error. Amber = attention needed. Never decoratively.

Success #1A7A4A <i>Graded, complete</i>	Success Light #E6F4ED <i>Badge background</i>	Error #C0392B <i>Missing pages, failed</i>	Error Light #FDECEA <i>Badge background</i>	Warning #C47D00 <i>Pending, attention</i>	Warning Light #FFF3CD <i>Badge background</i>
--	--	---	--	--	--

Neutral

Text #1A1A1A <i>All body text</i>	Muted #666666 <i>Labels, captions</i>	Border #CCCCCC <i>All borders</i>	Background #F5F5F5 <i>Page background</i>	Off-white #FAFAFA <i>Card backgrounds</i>
--	--	--	--	--

Cards sit on #F5F5F5 backgrounds. Card background is #FAFAFA. This separation makes cards visible without a border being needed.

2. Typography

One font only. Download Plus Jakarta Sans for free at fonts.google.com — install all weights before you start.

28px / Bold	Page title — one per page maximum
22px / SemiBold	Section heading
18px / SemiBold	Card heading
16px / Medium	Sub-heading, label above content group
14px / Regular	Body text — most of the interface. Line-height: 1.6
12px / Regular	Caption, helper text, timestamp. Colour: #666666
11px / Medium	SECTION LABEL — uppercase, letter-spacing 0.05em only

Rules:

- Sentence case on everything. Grade scripts, not Grade Scripts or GRADE SCRIPTS.
- Never bold body text. Bold is for headings only.
- Text on light backgrounds: #1A1A1A. Secondary text: #666666. Never go lighter than #666 for readable text.
- Text on dark/coloured backgrounds: use #F0F4FA (not pure white).

3. Spacing

Use only these values for all padding, margin, and gap. Nothing in between.

4px	Tiny — gap between icon and text
8px	Small — gap between tightly related elements
12px	Medium — gap between cards in a grid
16px	Large — padding inside components and cards
24px	XL — space between sections on a page
32px	2XL — space between major content groups
48px	3XL — page edge padding, top and bottom

4. Corner Radius

4px	Badges, tags, small chips
8px	Buttons, inputs, dropdowns
12px	Cards, modals, panels
100px	Pill-shaped status badges only

5. Buttons

Primary	#1A56A0 background. #F0F4FA text. 8px radius. 10px 20px padding. SemiBold 14px. One per screen.
Secondary	Transparent background. #1A56A0 text. 1.5px solid #1A56A0 border. Same size.
Danger	#C0392B background. #F0F4FA text. Same size. Destructive actions only.
Ghost	Transparent. #666666 text. No border. Minor actions like close or cancel.
Disabled	#F5F5F5 background. #CCCCCC text and border. Include helper text explaining why.

Always verb-first: Grade scripts, Upload file, Export results. Never: Submit, OK, Click here.

6. Status Badges

All badges: border-radius 100px, font-size 11px, font-weight 500. Always use the paired colours below.

Graded	#E6F4ED background / #1A7A4A text
In progress	#E8F1FB background / #0C3D7A text
Pending	#FFF3CD background / #7A4F00 text
Missing pages	#FDECEA background / #8B1A1A text
Not started	#F5F5F5 background / #444441 text
Flagged for review	#FFF3CD background / #7A4F00 text

7. Cards

Background	#FAFAFA (off-white, not pure white)
Border	1px solid #CCCCCC
Corner radius	12px
Padding	16px (24px for large feature cards)
Page background	#F5F5F5 — creates the contrast that makes cards visible
Shadow	None. Markelo is flat design. Borders separate, not shadows.

8. Icons

Icon library: Tabler Icons — tabler.io/icons. Outline style only. Never filled.

Size inline	16px — next to text
Size standalone	20px — interactive icons in interface
Size maximum	24px — decorative or feature icons
Colour	Always match the surrounding text colour. Never random colours.
In Figma	Install the Tabler Icons plugin from Figma Community.

9. Logo Brief

For Uchechi, Meklit, and Funmilayo. This is what the Markelo logo needs to work as.

Formats needed	Wordmark (name only). Icon + wordmark. Icon only (for small sizes).
Colour versions	Full colour on white. All white on blue. Dark navy on white.
Font in logo	Plus Jakarta Sans Bold — same font as the product.
Primary colour	#1A56A0 exactly.
Feeling	Professional, modern, African. Not playful. Not generic.
Icon guidance	Simple mark that works at 16x16 pixels. Abstract is fine. Avoid pencils, globes, graduation caps — too common.
File formats	SVG, PNG (transparent), PDF for print.
Minimum logo size	Must be readable at 24px height. Test at small size before finalising.

10. Social Media Sizes

LinkedIn profile	400 x 400px
LinkedIn banner	1584 x 396px
Twitter/X profile	400 x 400px
Twitter/X header	1500 x 500px
Instagram profile	400 x 400px
Instagram post	1080 x 1080px
Instagram story	1080 x 1920px
WhatsApp profile	640 x 640px — icon only, no text
Presentation slide	1920 x 1080px
Email signature	600 x 100px

11. Figma Setup Checklist

Do this before designing any screen:

- Add Plus Jakarta Sans via the Google Fonts plugin.
- Set page background to #F5F5F5.
- Create local colour styles using the names and hex codes below.
- Create text styles using the type scale in Section 2.
- Frame size: 390px wide (iPhone 14 Pro) for mobile-first.
- Name every layer clearly. Not Rectangle 42. Use: card-script, btn-primary, badge-graded.
- Share your Figma file link in Notion when you start.

Colour styles to create:

primary/blue	#1A56A0
primary/blue-light	#E8F1FB
primary/blue-dark	#0C3D7A
semantic/success	#1A7A4A
semantic/success-light	#E6F4ED
semantic/error	#C0392B
semantic/error-light	#FDECEA
semantic/warning	#C47D00
semantic/warning-light	#FFF3CD
neutral/text	#1A1A1A
neutral/muted	#666666
neutral/border	#CCCCCC
neutral/background	#F5F5F5
neutral/card	#FAFAFA
neutral/text-on-dark	#F0F4FA

Questions? Go to Oluwatomisin (Head of Design) first.